published magazine pieces and produced a television program for Dutch TV from his American images of race relations, all of which fueled his official entry into the prestigious photo agency Magnum.



FIGURE 1.13 Page spread, Leonard Freed, *Black in White America*, 1967/68. (Grossman/Estate of Leonard Freed)

By the time *Black in White America* was published, it was to some extent a testament that emerged a few years after its intended historical era. In other ways, it presented America's racial condition as still urgent and persistent. Absent an introduction or artist's statement, the book's epigraph carries the burden of offering an insight into what is at stake in the ongoing project of racial equality and justice. It quotes President Abraham Lincoln from an unnamed political debate: "Volumes have been written in defense of slavery, but I have never heard of any of these authors wanting to be slaves themselves."

The opening image of *Black in White America*, depicting the black American soldier by the Berlin Wall, picks up on this theme and serves its overall framing (fig. 1.13). Not only does Freed highlight the gap between language and visual experience in these opening gestures (perhaps this is also why only a handful of the images are captioned), but he suggests that acts of acknowledgment and identification carry a potential to reckon with